

WFLOW-02: Triggers & Event Types

Series: WFLOW — Workflows and Alert Notifications | Notebook: 2 of 10 | Created: January 2026 | Last Updated: 10/05/2026

Event-Driven Workflow Triggers

Triggers determine when workflows execute. This notebook covers all trigger types, detected problem events, Davis events, schedules, and custom event triggers.

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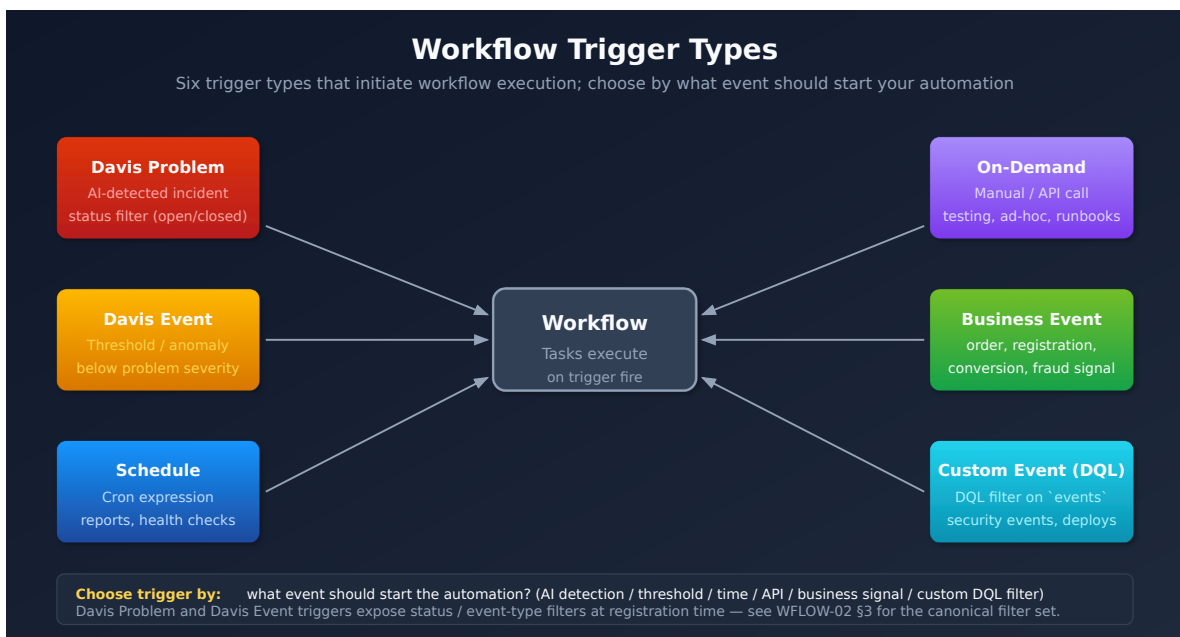
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Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Dynatrace Environment	SaaS with Platform subscription
Permissions	<code>automation:workflows:write</code>
Prior Knowledge	WFLOW-01: Workflow Fundamentals

1. Trigger Types Overview

Trigger Type	Fires When	Primary Use Case
Detected Problem	Dynatrace Intelligence detects/updates/closes a problem	Alert notifications, incident management
Davis Event	An anomaly detector raises a Davis event	Per-alert automation, before problem grouping
Schedule	Cron expression matches	Reports, health checks, cleanup jobs
On-Demand	Manual execution or API call	Testing, ad-hoc automation
Event	Business/custom event ingested	Business process automation



Choosing the Right Trigger

Scenario	Recommended Trigger
"Notify when a service is slow"	Detected Problem
"Alert when CPU > 90% for 5 mins"	An anomaly detector for the threshold (ALERT-02), then Detected Problem
"Send weekly status report"	Schedule
"Process order completion events"	Event (bizevents)
"Test my workflow"	On-Demand

2. Detected Problem Trigger

The most common trigger for alert notifications. Fires when Dynatrace Intelligence detects problems.

Trigger Configuration

Setting	Description	Example
Problem state	Active only, or active + closed	Active
Categories	Problem categories to include	Infrastructure, Application
Severity	The level at or above which problems start the workflow (see the SaaS 1.348 note in WFLOW-04 §3 before relying on it)	Any
Affected entities — tags	Tags the problem's affected entities must carry. Three modes: include all / all defined tags / any defined tag	team:checkout
Additional custom filter query	A DQL matcher on the incoming problem record (a subset of DQL — no aggregation, no querying across a set of events)	<code>maintenance.is_under_maintenance == false</code>
Updates	Re-trigger when selected fields change	Root cause changed

 **There is no Management Zone filter on the problem trigger.** An earlier revision of this notebook listed one; that was wrong. Dynatrace's upgrade guide describes the replacement directly: "A workflow's Problem trigger filters problems directly with DQL matchers on the problem. There is no separate filter object to create, name, and maintain, nor is there a one-management-zone-per-profile constraint." The trigger's configuration (problem state, event category, severity, affected-entity tags, custom filter) has no Management Zone option ([Event triggers for workflows \(DT docs\)](#)). Scope the trigger with **affected-entity tags** plus the custom DQL matcher instead.

This matters most if you are migrating off Management Zones: do not route on `event()` `["management_zones"]`. The field is **not present on problem records** — on a live tenant (10/05/2026) 0 of 15,878 problems in `dt.davis.problems` over 30 days carried it, while 14 of 15 hosts belonged to a management zone — so a condition that reads it has nothing to match, whether or not your zones still exist. Check your own tenant with `fetch dt.davis.problems, from:-30d | summarize n = countIf(isNotNull(management_zones))`. See MZ2POL-01 §5 for the full MZ-job-to-successor mapping.

Validate the filter before you save it. The trigger configuration offers **Query past events**, which estimates how many matching events occurred in your environment over recent windows. Use it

on every non-trivial trigger.

The result to distrust is **zero across every window in an environment you know is busy**. A trigger can be syntactically valid, save without error, and still never fire — nothing surfaces an error to tell you, because an over-constrained filter is not a malformed one. Check in particular that the **categories selected above and any category named in the custom filter query agree**: a matcher narrowing to a category you did not select leaves nothing that can ever match. Reading the estimate at authoring time costs seconds and is the only signal you get.

Problem Event Data

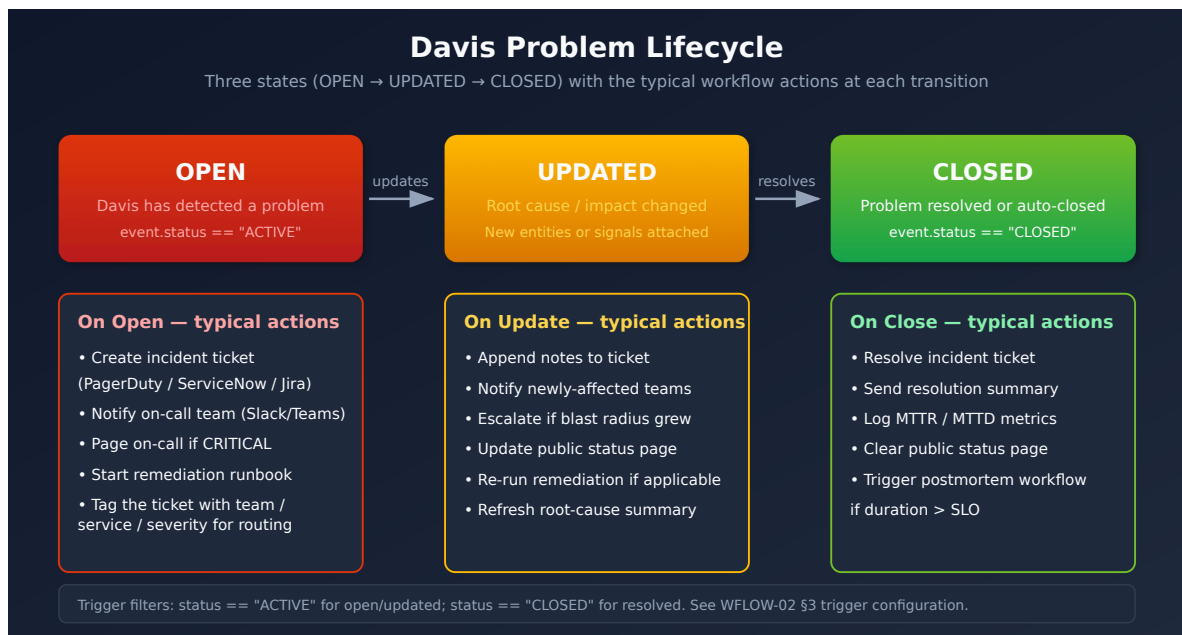
The payload is the `dt.davis.problems` record. Run `fetch dt.davis.problems, from:-24h | limit 1` to see every field your templates can read. An abridged record (field names as returned by a live tenant, 09/24/2026):

```
{
  "display_id": "P-260911127",
  "event.id": "-1001992832270454690_1790253360000V2",
  "event.name": "High response time on checkout service",
  "event.category": "SLOWDOWN",
  "event.status": "ACTIVE",
  "event.status_transition": "CREATED",
  "event.severity": "3",
  "event.start": "2026-09-24T12:37:00.000000000Z",
  "affected_entity_ids": ["SERVICE-ABC123"],
  "smartscape.affected_entities": [{"id": "SERVICE-ABC123", "name": "checkout", "type": "SERVICE"}],
  "entity_tags": ["team:checkout"],
  "maintenance.is_under_maintenance": false
}
```

There is no `title`, `status`, `problem_url` or `start_time` field. The link to the problem comes from the `{{ problem_link() }}` expression, not from the record. §7 has the full mapping.

Problem Lifecycle Events

Event	When	Typical Action
Problem opened	New problem detected	Create incident, notify team
Problem updated	Root cause/impact changed	Update incident notes
Problem closed	Problem resolved	Close incident, send summary



Example: Filter Critical Production Problems

```
trigger:
  type: davis-problem
  config:
    categories:
      - AVAILABILITY
      - PERFORMANCE
    entityTagsMatch: all
    entityTags:
      - key: env
        value: prod
```

3. Davis Event Trigger

React to an individual Davis event, the alert an anomaly detector raises, rather than to the problem Dynatrace groups those alerts into.

This trigger does not evaluate a threshold. Dynatrace documents it as *"Davis event trigger — Starts on individual alerts when anomalies are detected."* The threshold itself lives in an anomaly detector (**AIOPS-02, ALERT-02**); the trigger reacts to the Davis event that detector raises. An earlier revision of this notebook showed a trigger with its own DQL query and evaluation frequency. That trigger does not exist.

When to Use

The upgrade guide's advice: *"Trigger on problems, not on Davis events. Dynatrace Intelligence groups related alerts into one problem. Triggering on raw events bypasses that grouping and floods the channel. Use the Davis event trigger only when you genuinely need per-alert granularity."* Typical cases:

- Automation on non-problem events, such as deployments, configuration changes and informational signals
- A per-alert action where the grouped problem is too coarse

Configuration

Setting	Description
Problem state	active, active or closed, or closed
Davis event name	equals / contains a string
Affected entities	Filter by entity tags (all entities / all defined tags / any defined tag)
Maintenance window	Always, inside maintenance window only, or outside maintenance window only
Additional custom filter query	A DQL matcher over the Davis event record

Event Data

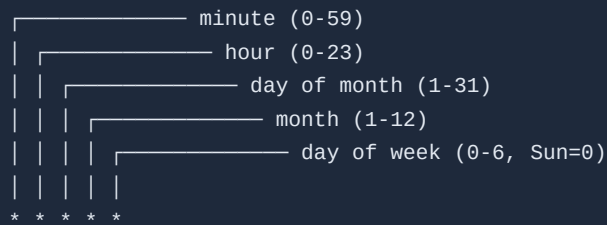
The payload is the `dt.davis.events` record. Run `fetch dt.davis.events, from:-24h | limit 1` to see its fields. Commonly used: `event.name`, `event.category`, `event.status`, `event.start`, `dt.source_entity`, `dt.smartscape_source.id`, `entity_tags`.

Sources: [Event triggers for workflows \(DT docs\)](#), [Upgrade guide — alerting and notifications \(DT docs\)](#).

4. Schedule Trigger

Execute workflows on a recurring schedule using cron expressions.

Cron Expression Format



A diagram illustrating the components of a cron expression. It shows a sequence of five vertical bars, each representing a field. From left to right, the fields are: minute (0-59), hour (0-23), day of month (1-31), month (1-12), and day of week (0-6, Sun=0). Each field is connected to its corresponding label by a horizontal line. Below the bars, there are five asterisks, one for each field, indicating the default value for each field.

Common Schedules

Schedule	Cron Expression	Description
Every hour	<code>0 * * * *</code>	Top of every hour
Daily at 9 AM	<code>0 9 * * *</code>	Every day at 9:00
Weekdays at 8 AM	<code>0 8 * * 1-5</code>	Mon-Fri at 8:00
First of month	<code>0 0 1 * *</code>	1st day, midnight
Every 15 minutes	<code>*/15 * * * *</code>	0, 15, 30, 45 past

Example: Daily Health Check Report

```
trigger:
  type: schedule
  config:
    cron: "0 9 * * 1-5" # Weekdays at 9 AM
    timezone: "America/New_York"
```

Schedule Best Practices

- **Avoid minute 0** - Many workflows run at :00, spread load
- **Use timezones** - Be explicit about timezone
- **Consider rate limits** - Don't schedule too frequently

5. On-Demand Trigger

Manual execution for testing, ad-hoc runs, or API-triggered automation.

Manual Execution

1. Open workflow in editor
2. Click **Run** button
3. Optionally provide input parameters
4. View execution results

API Execution

Trigger workflows programmatically via API:

```
curl -X POST "https://&lt;env&gt;/platform/automation/v1/workflows/&lt;id&gt;/run" \
-H "Authorization: Bearer &lt;platform-token&gt;" \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{"input": {"environment": "prod", "notify_slack": true}}'
```

The platform token needs the `automation:workflows:run` scope. Platform tokens use `Bearer`, not `Api-Token`: *"To use a platform token please provide the token in the Authorization header: `Authorization: Bearer` "* ([Platform tokens \(DT docs\)](#)).

Workflow Inputs

Values passed as `input` arrive as workflow inputs. *"The input is a merge of the default workflow inputs and the inputs provided at runtime."* Read them in tasks with `input()`:

```
{{ input('environment') }}
{{ input('notify_slack') }}
```

Sources: [Monitor workflow executions \(DT docs\)](#) — the run endpoint's `input` and `params` attributes, [Jinja expressions for Workflows \(DT docs\)](#) — `input()`.

6. Event Trigger (Custom/Business Events)

Trigger on business events or custom events ingested into Grail.

Use Cases

- **Order completed** → Update inventory system
- **User registered** → Send welcome notification
- **Deployment finished** → Run validation tests
- **Custom alert** → External system integration

Configuration

```
trigger:
  type: event
  config:
    eventType: "com.company.order-completed"
    filterQuery: |
      event.type == "com.company.order-completed"
      AND order.total > 1000
```

Sending Business Events

Ingest events via API:

```
curl -X POST "https://&env&api/v2/bizevents/ingest" \
-H "Authorization: Api-Token &token&" \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{
  "type": "com.company.order-completed",
  "data": {
    "order_id": "ORD-12345",
    "customer": "ACME Corp",
    "total": 1500.00
  }
}'
```

Event Data

Access event fields in tasks:

```
{{ event()["data"]["order_id"] }}
{{ event()["data"]["customer"] }}
{{ event()["data"]["total"] }}
```

Business events never open problems

That is a feature of this trigger, not a gap. A record ingested through `/api/v2/bizevents/ingest` lands in Grail as a business event: queryable, and able to trigger a workflow exactly as shown above — but it never raises a Davis problem and never enters problem correlation. `dt.smartscape_source.id`, the correlation key that decides which Davis events merge into one problem (AIOPS-03 §1), is not part of this path and does not apply here.

If what you actually want is a problem, this is the wrong API. Custom *Davis* events go to `/api/v2/events/ingest` with an `entitySelector` naming the entity the signal is about. Omitting that selector is the classic mistake: the event associates with the environment entity rather than a real one — so instead of failing to merge, it merges with every other environment-scoped alert in the tenant into

one problem that names nothing actionable. S2D-05 works through that failure in a scheduled-workflow context.

Sources: [Ingest an event — POST /api/v2/events/ingest \(DT docs\)](#) — "If not set, the event is associated with the environment (`dt.entity.environment`) entity.", [Avoid overalerting \(DT docs\)](#).

7. Trigger Data and Expressions

Accessing Trigger Data

Expression	Returns	Example
<code>{{ event() }}</code>	Full event object	<code>{"event.name": "...", ...}</code>
<code>{{ event()["field"] }}</code>	Specific field	<code>"High response time"</code>
<code>{{ event().get("field", "default") }}</code>	Field with a fallback	<code>"n/a"</code>
<code>{{ execution() }}</code>	Current execution (id, state, started_at, workflow)	<code>{"state": "RUNNING", ...}</code>
<code>{{ input("name") }}</code>	A workflow input (on-demand / API runs)	<code>"prod"</code>
<code>{{ problem_link() }}</code>	URL of the problem (Problem trigger only)	<code>https://.../ui/apps/dynatrace.davis.problems/problem/...</code>

There is no `trigger()` expression. Field names contain dots, so use bracket access: `event()["event.name"]`, not `event().event.name`.

Common Event Fields by Trigger Type

Detected Problem (the `dt.davis.problems` record):

```

{{ event()["display_id"] }}      # P-260911127
{{ event()["event.id"] }}      # Problem ID ({PID} in Classic)
{{ event()["event.name"] }}    # Problem title
{{ event()["event.category"] }} # AVAILABILITY, ERROR, SLOWDOWN,
RESOURCE_CONTENTION, CUSTOM_ALERT, ...
{{ event()["event.status"] }}   # ACTIVE or CLOSED
{{ event()["event.severity"] }} # 1-5 (1 = most severe); experimental, may be
absent
{{ event()["event.start"] }}    # When the problem opened
{{ event()["affected_entity_ids"] }} # Array of entity IDs
{{ event()["root_cause_entity_id"] }} # Root cause entity (when determined)
{{ event()["management_zones"] }} # Legacy – not present on problem records (0 of
15,878 over 30 days); do not route on this
{{ problem_link() }}           # Link to problem

```

Davis Event: the `dt.davis.events` record — `event.name`, `event.category`, `event.status`, `event.start`, `dt.source_entity` (see §3).

Schedule: no event payload. Use `{{ execution().started_at }}` or `{{ now() }}`.

Classic placeholder and old-template mapping

Templates written for Dynatrace Classic, and earlier revisions of this series, read fields the problem record does not have. Depending on how a missing field is read, the task fails with *Undefined variables* (bracket access) or the value is empty and every comparison is false (`.get()` with a default) — the second is silent. Use this mapping:

Replace	With	Note
<code>event()["title"]</code>	<code>event()["event.name"]</code>	<code>{ProblemTitle}</code>
<code>event()["status"]</code>	<code>event()["event.status"]</code>	Values <code>ACTIVE</code> / <code>CLOSED</code> , never <code>OPEN</code>
<code>event()</code> <code>["start_time"]</code> , <code>event()</code> <code>["end_time"]</code>	<code>event()["event.start"]</code> , <code>event()</code> <code>["event.end"]</code>	<code>{startTime}</code> , <code>{endTime}</code>
<code>event()</code> <code>["problem_url"]</code>	<code>{{ problem_link() }}</code>	<code>{ProblemURL}</code> ; Problem trigger only
<code>event()</code> <code>["problem_id"]</code>	<code>event()["event.id"]</code>	<code>{PID}</code>
<code>event()["severity"]</code> <code>== "CRITICAL"</code>	<code>event()["event.category"] ==</code> <code>"AVAILABILITY"</code> (kind of problem), or <code>(event().get("event.severity") \ int(5))</code> <code><= 2</code> (1–5 scale)	<code>event.severity</code> is experimental ; see WFLOW-04 §3

Sources: [Jinja expressions for Workflows \(DT docs\)](#) — the expression list (`event()` , `execution()` , `input()` , `problem_link()`). [Upgrade guide — alerting and notifications \(DT docs\)](#) — the placeholder-to-field mapping; `{ProblemURL}` → `{{ problem_link() }}` : "Evaluates only in workflows with a Davis problem trigger". **Dictionary:** `event.name` , `event.status` , `event.category` (`stable`), `event.severity` (`experimental`), read 09/24/2026.

8. Davis Problem Event Payload Reference

Rewritten 09/24/2026 from `fetch dt.davis.problems` on a live tenant and the upgrade guide's placeholder mapping. The previous revision of this table listed `title` , `problem_id` , `status` , `start_time` , `impacted_entities` and `problem_url` as always present. None of them is on the problem record. Payload fields can change between releases: re-run `fetch dt.davis.problems, from:-24h | limit 1` before building routing on an uncommon field.

Workflows on a Detected Problem trigger receive one `event` object: the `dt.davis.problems` record at the moment the trigger fired. Sections 2 and 7 show common access patterns; this section is the reference: the fields you can rely on, when they appear, how they join to DQL, and which downstream notebooks consume them.

8.1. Top-Level Field Reference

Field	Type	Present	Notes
<code>event.kind</code>	string	Always	"DAVIS_PROBLEM" for this trigger. Distinguishes from <code>DAVIS_EVENT</code> (raw signals).
<code>display_id</code>	string	Always	Human-facing problem ID ("P-260911127"). Use in notifications and ticket subjects.
<code>event.id</code>	string	Always	Problem ID (<code>{PID}</code> in Classic). Use to join to <code>fetch dt.davis.problems</code> (see §8.3).
<code>event.name</code>	string	Always	Problem title (<code>{ProblemTitle}</code>).

Field	Type	Present	Notes
<code>event.category</code>	string	Always	<code>AVAILABILITY</code> , <code>ERROR</code> , <code>SLOWDOWN</code> , <code>RESOURCE_CONTENTION</code> , <code>CUSTOM_ALERT</code> , <code>MONITORING_UNAVAILABLE</code> , <code>INFO</code> . <code>{ProblemSeverity}</code> maps here.
<code>event.status</code>	string	Always	<code>ACTIVE</code> or <code>CLOSED</code> . The documented open/close discriminator.
<code>event.status_transition</code>	string	Always	<code>CREATED</code> , <code>UPDATED</code> , <code>REFRESHED</code> , <code>RESOLVED</code> , <code>CLOSED</code> . <code>experimental</code> in the dictionary.
<code>event.severity</code>	1–5	Usually	1 = most severe, 5 = least. <code>experimental</code> . Arrives as a string ("3") on the validation tenant, so convert with <code>\ int</code> . No longer defaulted from SaaS 1.348 (WFLOW-04 §3).
<code>event.start</code>	timestamp	Always	When the problem opened (<code>{startTime}</code>) .
<code>event.end</code>	timestamp	Closed only	When the problem closed (<code>{endTime}</code>) .
<code>event.description</code>	string	Usually	Markdown problem details (<code>{ProblemDetailsText}</code>) .
<code>affected_entity_ids</code>	string[]	Always	Classic entity IDs. Deprecated in favor of <code>smartscape.affected_entities</code> .
<code>smartscape.affected_entities</code>	record[]	Usually	Each element has <code>id</code> , <code>type</code> , <code>name</code> — the entity <i>name</i> without an extra lookup.
<code>affected_entity_types</code>	string[]	Always	Entity types touched by this problem. Useful for routing without enumerating IDs.
<code>root_cause_entity_id</code>	string	When determined	Deprecated in favor of <code>root_cause.smartscape_entity</code> . Often empty early in the lifecycle.

Field	Type	Present	Notes
<code>entity_tags</code>	<code>string[]</code>	When tagged	<code>key:value</code> strings (<code>"team:checkout"</code>), not objects. Deprecated in favor of <code>primary_tags.*</code> .
<code>primary_tags.*</code>	<code>string</code>	When enriched	Primary Grail tags propagated from the alerting events.
<code>dt.davis.event_ids</code>	<code>string[]</code>	Always	The Davis events grouped into this problem.
<code>maintenance.is_under_maintenance</code>	<code>boolean</code>	Always	Whether the problem falls in a maintenance window.
<code>dt.duration_marker</code>	<code>string</code>	Usually	Stepped open-duration marker used by the trigger's Minimum duration option.
<code>resolved_problem_duration</code>	<code>duration (ns)</code>	Closed only	Final duration once resolved.

There is no `problem_url` field. Use the `{{ problem_link() }}` expression.

Sources: [Event triggers for workflows \(DT docs\)](#) — *"To browse past occurrences, explore available fields, and test filter conditions before configuring the trigger, run this query in a notebook"*. [Upgrade guide — alerting and notifications \(DT docs\)](#) — the placeholder mapping and the deprecations: *"root_cause_entity_id and root_cause_entity_name are deprecated in favor of root_cause.smartscape_entity, and affected_entity_ids in favor of smartscape.affected_entities."* **Dictionary:** `event.name`, `event.status`, `event.category (stable)`, `event.severity`, `event.status_transition (experimental)`, read 09/24/2026. **Observed 09/24/2026:** the *Present* column records a 7-day field-presence count on a validation tenant — what one tenant's payloads carried, not a documented guarantee.

Where the entity fields come from. `affected_entity_ids`, `root_cause_entity_id`, and `smartscape.affected_entities` are populated from the Davis events Dynatrace grouped into this problem, and that grouping runs on `dt.smartscape_source.id` — the Smartscape entity ID an event carries when it is properly attributed (84.9% of Davis events on a validation tenant over 7 days, 08/11/2026). Events naming the same entity within the correlation window merge into the single problem this payload describes.

That has a direct consequence for anyone reading these fields in a workflow: a problem assembled from **mis-attributed** events arrives with those fields populated by the *environment* entity rather than the thing that broke, so routing that branches on `affected_entity_types`, `entity_tags`, or `root_cause_entity_id` silently falls through to its default — the environment entity carries none of the team or service tags the routing expects. If a workflow keeps landing on the fallback branch, suspect

the upstream detector's event template before rewriting the routing logic. Note the accompanying symptom is over-merge, not a problem-count spike: an event template that leaves `dt.smartscape_source.id` unset makes every such alert name the same entity, so they collapse into one implausibly broad problem. AIOPS-03 §1 covers the correlation rules, AIOPS-02 §8 finds unattributed detectors in your own tenant, and ALERT-99 §3 explains which Davis data object to count when you audit.

Sources: [Avoid overalerting \(DT docs\)](#).

8.2. Lifecycle Field Presence

With **Problem state** set to *active or closed*, a single workflow fires when the problem opens and again when it closes (and on field changes, if **Updates** is enabled). The payload differs between the two, so guard logic that assumes every field is populated will mis-route close events.

Field	<code>event.status = ACTIVE</code>	<code>event.status = CLOSED</code>
<code>display_id</code> , <code>event.id</code> , <code>event.name</code> , <code>event.category</code>	✓	✓
<code>event.start</code>	✓	✓
<code>event.end</code> , <code>resolved_problem_duration</code>	—	✓
<code>root_cause_entity_id</code>	sometimes empty	populated when determined
<code>affected_entity_ids</code> , <code>smartscape.affected_entities</code>	initial set, may expand	final set

`event.status_transition` has five values (`CREATED`, `UPDATED`, `REFRESHED`, `RESOLVED`, `CLOSED`), and a close record can carry `RESOLVED` or `UPDATED` rather than `CLOSED`. Branch on `event.status`, which the upgrade guide uses for the close notification ("*build a second workflow filtering `event.status == 'CLOSED'`*"), then read only the fields present for that branch.

8.3. Joining the Payload to DQL

The workflow payload is a snapshot. For longer-window analysis (problem history, MTTR, fleet-wide patterns), join the payload's `event.id` to the canonical Grail table:

```
// Hydrate the workflow payload against the full Davis problems record.
// Substitute {{ event()["event.id"] }} via a DQL workflow task.
fetch dt.davis.problems, from:-7d
| filter event.id == "{{ event()['event.id'] }}"
| fields display_id,
        event.name,
        event.category,
        event.status,
        event.start,
        event.end,
        smartscape.affected_entities,
        affected_entity_ids,
        root_cause_entity_id
| limit 1
```

Why `dt.davis.problems` and not `dt.davis.events` : `dt.davis.problems` is the canonical problems data object; `dt.davis.events` carries only `DAVIS_EVENT` records (raw signals that *feed* problem detection, not the problems themselves). Querying `dt.davis.events` for problem records returns zero rows on modern tenants.

For aggregate views (e.g., "all problems for the same entity this week") swap the filter:

```
fetch dt.davis.problems, from:-7d
| filter in("{{ event()['affected_entity_ids'][0] }}", affected_entity_ids)
| summarize problem_count = count(), by:{event.category, event.status}
| sort problem_count desc
```


8.4. Common Access Patterns

```
# Display ID and link – every notification
{{ event()["display_id"] }}
{{ problem_link() }}

# Category-based routing (see WFLOW-04 §3 for severity tiers)
{% if event()["event.category"] == "AVAILABILITY" %} page on-call
{% elif event()["event.category"] == "ERROR" %}      notify channel
{% else %}                                          log only
{% endif %}

# Lifecycle branch – distinguishes open from close in the same workflow
{% if event()["event.status"] == "CLOSED" %} close ticket
{% else %}                                create/update ticket
{% endif %}

# Custom-tag access (entity_tags is an array of "key:value" strings)
{% for tag in event().get("entity_tags", []) %}
  {% if tag.startswith("team:") %}{{ tag.split(":", 1)[1] }}{% endif %}
{% endfor %}

# Entity-type filtering – route by what kind of entity is involved
{% if "SERVICE" in event()["affected_entity_types"] %} service-team channel
{% elif "HOST" in event()["affected_entity_types"] %}   infra channel
{% endif %}

# Affected entity names (no extra lookup – smartscape.affected_entities carries names)
{% for ent in event().get("smartscape.affected_entities", []) %}
  {{ ent["name"] }} ({{ ent["type"] }})
{% endfor %}
```

8.5. Cross-References

- **WFLOW-04 §3 Routing by Severity** consumes `event.severity` and `event.category` from this payload to fan notifications out to team channels.
- **WFLOW-04 §4 Routing by Team/Service** reads entity tags (custom tags like `team:checkout`) and `affected_entity_types` .
- **WFLOW-05 Incident Management** uses `display_id` , `{{ problem_link() }}` , `event.status` , and `event.start` to create and update tickets through the lifecycle.
- **WFLOW-07 Remediation** branches on `root_cause_entity_id` and `event.name` to pick the right runbook task, and joins `event.id` to `dt.davis.problems` for richer context before acting.

8.6. Caveats

- **Old field names fail, sometimes silently.** A template that reads `title` , `status` , `problem_url` or `start_time` either errors (*Undefined variables*) or, when read through `.get()` , prints nothing and

compares false. If a task errors on a template, or a notification arrives with blank fields, check the field names against \$7's mapping first.

- **Re-verify before load-bearing logic.** This reference is dated 09/24/2026. The payload is product surface and can change in a sprint. Spot-check a real payload (a logging task, or `fetch dt.davis.problems, from:-24h | limit 1`) in your tenant before relying on a field in production routing.

Query Detected Problems

```
// Recent detected problems that could trigger workflows
// Field names corrected 09/24/2026: `severity` / `status` are not the problem fields;
// the trigger
// payload uses `event.category` and `event.status` (ACTIVE / CLOSED).
fetch events, from: now() - 24h
| filter event.kind == "DAVIS_PROBLEM"
| fields timestamp,
           display_id,
           event.name,
           event.category,
           event.status,
           affected_entity_ids,
           root_cause_entity_id
| sort timestamp desc
| limit 20
```

```
// Distinct problems by category that were ACTIVE at any point in the last 7 days
// Counted with countDistinctExact(display_id) since 09/24/2026: `events` holds one
// record per
// problem update, so count() over-reported problems 4-35x on the validation tenant.
// Field names corrected 08/12/2026: on `events`, a Davis problem carries `event.status`
// and
// `event.category` – there are no bare `status` / `severity` fields, so those filters
// matched
// nothing. `event.status` values are ACTIVE / CLOSED – "OPEN" is not one of them.
fetch events, from:-7d
| filter event.kind == "DAVIS_PROBLEM"
| filter event.status == "ACTIVE"
| summarize problem_count = countDistinctExact(display_id), by:{event.category}
| sort problem_count desc
```

```
// Business events that could trigger workflows
fetch bizevents, from: now() - 24h
| summarize event_count = count(), by:{event.type}
| sort event_count desc
| limit 20
```

Next Steps

Now that you understand triggers, learn to send notifications:

Recommended Path

1. **WFLOW-03: Alert Notification Basics** - Slack, Teams, email notifications
2. **WFLOW-04: Advanced Notification Routing** - Conditional routing
3. **WFLOW-07: Problem-Triggered Remediation** - Auto-remediation patterns

Key Takeaways

- **Detected Problem** triggers for AI-detected incidents
- **Davis Event** triggers for per-alert reactions to anomaly detectors (thresholds live in the detector)
- **Schedule** triggers for recurring tasks
- **On-Demand** triggers for testing and API integration
- **Event** triggers for business events
- Use expressions like `{{ event()["field"] }}` to access data

Summary

In this notebook, you learned:

- All five trigger types and when to use each
- How to configure Detected Problem triggers with filters
- When to use a Davis event trigger instead of a Problem trigger
- Cron expressions for schedule triggers
- On-demand execution via UI and API
- Business event triggers for custom automation
- How to access trigger data in expressions

References

- [Workflow triggers \(DT docs\)](#)
- [Workflow reference / Jinja expressions \(DT docs\)](#)
- [Davis Problems app \(DT docs\)](#)

- [Business Observability umbrella \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [Workflows umbrella \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [Cron expression sandbox \(crontab.guru\)](#)
 - [Upgrade guide — alerting and notifications \(DT docs\)](#)
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